

DE-ESCALATION SCRIPT LIBRARY

Verbal Strategies for High-Stress Encounters

**CRITICAL RULE: Never use "debt talk."
Avoid terms like foreclosure, delinquency, past due, default, in arrears, or late on payments.
These are triggers that ignite hostility.**

SCENARIO 1: STANDARD INTRODUCTION (The "Property Update" Frame)

"Hello, my name is [Name]. I'm an independent contractor here to provide a routine property condition update for the lender's records. I'll just be a few minutes documenting the exterior."

SCENARIO 2: THE AGITATED OCCUPANT (Emotional De-escalation)

"I realize this situation is frustrating. My goal is simply to provide an accurate, objective report of the property status for the file."

If they remain aggressive: *"I am here to help by providing a neutral report. If you're not comfortable right now, I can contact my coordinator and we can determine a better time to return."*

SCENARIO 3: THE HOSTILE NEIGHBOR (The Rannort Bridge)

"I understand your concern for the neighborhood. I'm here on behalf of the financial institution to ensure the property is being properly maintained and is secure."

SCENARIO 4: EMPOWERMENT THROUGH CHOICE (Restoring Autonomy)

"Would you feel more comfortable if I completed the exterior photos first while you wait inside, or would you prefer to stand by the front door while I finish?"

SCENARIO 5: THE BANKRUPTCY/NO-CONTACT SCRIPT

Note: *On these orders, your goal is zero contact. If confronted:*

"I am here to take exterior-only photos for a property record update. I am not permitted to discuss any account details. Please contact your legal counsel or the lender directly for information."